LLL-C-83B
November 14, 1977
SUPERSEDING
LLL-C-0083A(DSA-DM)
June 21, 1967 and
LLL-C-83
February 10, 1949

FEDERAL SPECIFICATION

CANES, WALKING

This specification was approved by the Commissioner, Federal Supply Service, General Services Administration, for the use of all Federal agencies.

1. SCOPE AND CLASSIFICATION

1.1 Scope. This specification covers walking canes (see 6.1).

1.2 Classification.

1.2.1 Types and classes. Walking canes covered by this specification shall be of the following types and classes, as specified (see 6.2):

Types:
- I. - Plain.
- II. - Steel tipped.

Classes:
- A. - Clear finish.
- B. - White finish.
- C. - White finish with red band.

2. APPLICABLE DOCUMENTS

2.1 The following documents of the issue in effect on date of invitation for bids or request for proposals form a part of this specification to the extent specified herein.

FSC 6515

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Federal Specifications:

TT-L-58	-	Lacquer, Spraying, Clear and Pigmented Cellulose Nitrate (General Interior Use).
TT-V-121	-	Varnish, Spar, Water-resisting.
PPP-B-585	-	Boxes, Wood, Wirebound.
PPP-B-601	-	Boxes, Wood, Cleated-Plywood.
PPP-B-621	-	Boxes, Wood, Nailed and Lock-Corner.
PPP-B-636	-	Boxes, Shipping, Fiberboard.

Federal Standards:

Fed. Std. No. 123 - Marking for Shipment (Civil Agencies).

(Activities outside the Federal Government may obtain copies of Federal Specifications, Standards, and Handbooks as outlined under General Information in the Index of Federal Specifications and Standards and at the prices indicated in the Index. The Index, which includes cumulative monthly supplements as issued, is for sale on a subscription basis by the Superintendent of Documents, U.S. Government Printing Office, Washington, DC 20402.

(Single copies of this specification and other Federal Specifications required by activities outside the Federal Government for bidding purposes are available without charge from Business Service Centers, at the General Services Administration Regional Offices in Boston, New York, Washington, DC, Philadelphia, Atlanta, Chicago, Kansas City, MO, Fort Worth, Houston, Denver, San Francisco, Los Angeles and Seattle, WA.

(Federal Government activities may obtain copies of Federal Specifications, Standards and Handbooks and the Index of Federal Specifications and Standards from established distribution points in their agencies.)

Military Specifications:

MIL-L-10547	-	Liners, Case and Sheet, Overwrap; Water-vaporproof or Waterproof, Flexible.

Military Standards:

MIL-STD-105	-	Sampling Procedures and Tables for Inspection by Attributes.
MIL-STD-129	-	Marking for Shipment and Storage.
MIL-STD-1363	-	Measurement of Wood Moisture Content.

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(Copies of Military Specifications, Standards, and Publications required by suppliers in connection with specific procurement functions should be obtained from the procuring activity or as directed by the contracting officer.)

2.2 Other publications. The following publication forms a part of this specification to the extent specified herein. Unless otherwise specified, the issue in effect on date of invitation for bids or request for proposals shall apply.

Publication No. 74 - College of Environmental Science and Forestry, State University of New York.

(Application for copies should be addressed to State University of New York, College of Environmental Science and Forestry Publications, Syracuse, New York 13210.

3. REQUIREMENTS

3.1 Material. The material shall be clear, straight grained (fibers parallel to the axis of the piece) white ash, cherry, rock elm, hickory, red oak, or hard maple. Identification shall be determined as specified in 4.4.1.

3.1.1 Seasoning. The moisture content of the canes shall not exceed 15 percent based on oven dry weight, when tested as specified in 4.4.2.

3.2 Size.

3.2.1 Type I, plain. Type I canes shall be made to conform to figure 1. The cane shall be tapered to fit a rubber cane tip 3/4 inch inside diameter and 1-1/4 inch inside depth.

3.2.2 Type II, steel-tipped. Type II canes shall be round, 7/8 inch (2.22 cm) + 1/32 inch (.079 cm) in diameter at the handle end, and shall taper, beginning 1-1/2 to 2 inches from distal end, gradually to 1/2 inch (1.27 cm) + zero - 1/16 inch (.16 cm) in diameter at the distal end. The over-all length shall be 36 inches (91.44 cm), 38 inches, (96.5 cm), 40 inches (101.6 cm), 42 inches (106.7 cm), or 44 inches (111.76 cm) with a tolerance of ± 1/2 inch (1.27 cm), as specified (see 6.2).

3.3 Tip. Type II canes shall be securely fitted with a suitably hard stainless steel tip approximately 1-1/2 inches (3.81 cm) long and tapering from 5/8 inch (1.59 cm) in diameter at the top opening to 1/2 inch (1.27 cm) in diameter at the closed bottom. The bottom of the tip that touches the ground, shall be solid steel for approximately 1/2 inch (1.27 cm), beveled or rounded to prevent catching in small crevices when pushed along the road surface.

3.4 Handle. The handle shall be integral with the shaft, for both type I and type II canes.

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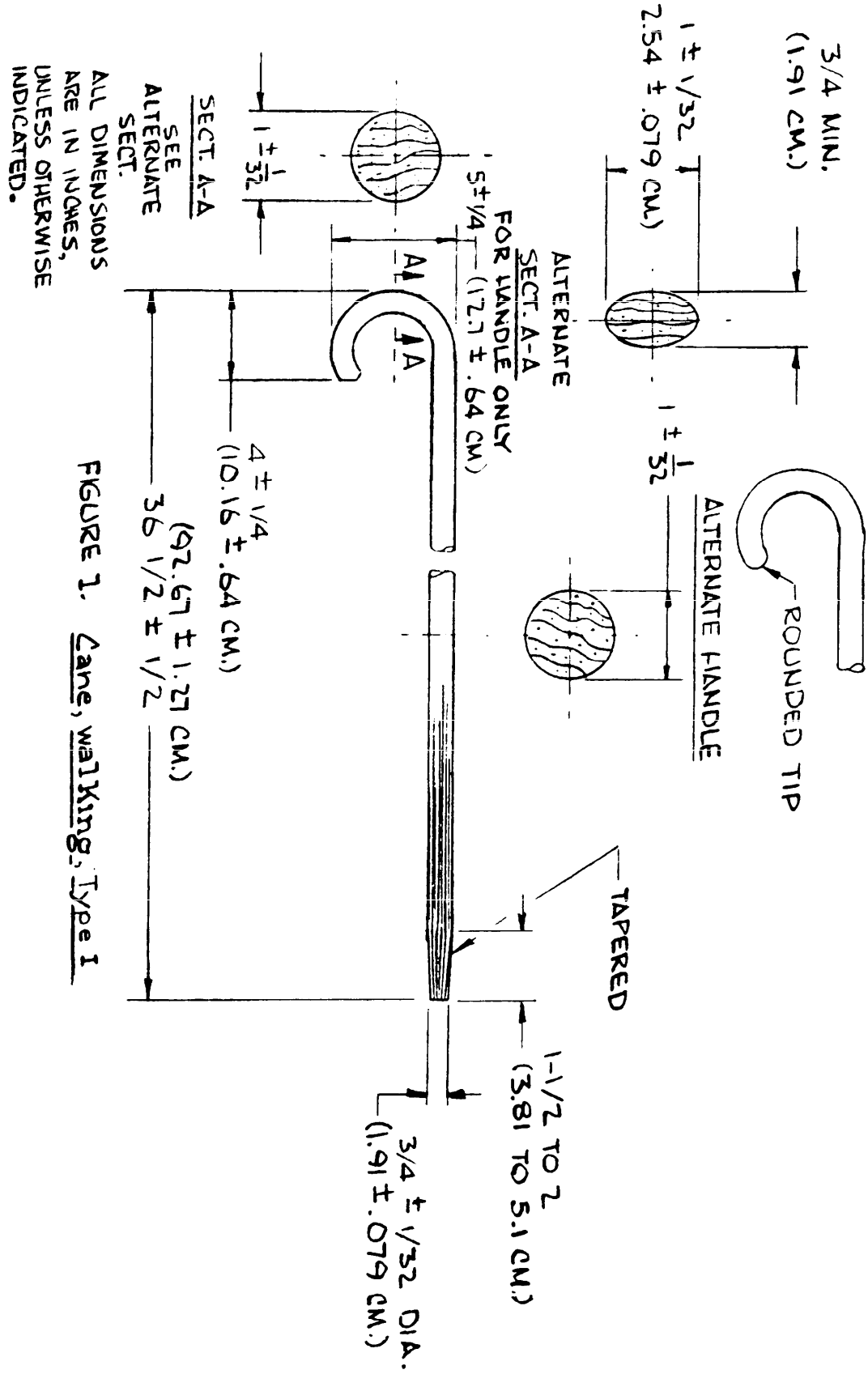


FIGURE 1. Cane, walking: Type I

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3.5 Finish. The cane wood shall be sanded smooth, free from splinters and Class A, Class B, or Class C finish applied as specified (see 6.2).

3.5.1 Class A, clear finish. The finish for class A canes shall consist of two coats of clear spar varnish conforming to TT-V-121.

3.5.2 Class B, white finish. The finish for class B canes shall consist of two or more coats (sufficient to provide a satisfactory appearance) of white lacquer conforming to type II of TT-L-58. The lacquer shall be applied over an appropriate sealer.

3.5.3 Class C, white finish with red band. The finish for class C canes shall be the same as the finish for class B canes, with the addition of a band of chinese red lacquer extending along the cane for approximately six inches from the top of the steel tip. The lacquer shall conform to type II of TT-L-58.

3.6 Workmanship. Workmanship shall be first class throughout. The cane shall be free from all defects that detract from its appearance or may impair its serviceability.

4. QUALITY ASSURANCE PROVISIONS

4.1 Responsibility for inspection. Unless otherwise specified in the contract, the contractor is responsible for the performance of all inspection requirements as specified herein. Except as otherwise specified in the contract, the contractor may use his own or any other facilities suitable for the performance of the inspection requirements specified herein, unless disapproved by the Government. The Government reserves the right to perform any of the inspections set forth in the specification where such inspections are deemed necessary to assure that supplies and services conform to prescribed requirements.

4.1.1 Records. Records of examinations and tests performed by or for the contractor shall be maintained by the contractor and made available to the Government, upon the Government's request, at any time, or from time to time, during the performance of the contract and for a period of three years after delivery of the supplies to which such records relate.

4.1.2 Inspection. Inspection, as used in this specification, is defined as both examination (such as visual or auditory investigation without the use of special laboratory appliances or procedures) and testing (determination by technical means of physical and chemical properties) of the item.

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4.1.3 Certificates of quality. Certificates of quality supplied by the manufacturer of the component or materials may be furnished in lieu of actual performance of such testing by the contractor, provided lot identity has been maintained and can be demonstrated to the Government. The certificate shall include the name of the contractor, the contract number, the name of the manufacturer or supplier, the NSN, the item identification, the name of the component/material, the lot number, the lot size, the sample size, the date of testing, the test method, the individual test results, and the specification requirements.

4.2 Sampling.

4.2.1 For examination. Sampling for examination shall be conducted in accordance with MIL-STD-105 and as indicated in table I. The unit of product for examination purposes shall be one cane.

TABLE I. Sampling criteria for examination

Type defect	Inspection level	AQL (percent defective)
Major	I	1.0
Minor	I	4.5
Dimensional	S-3	2.5

4.2.2 Dimensional. Examination shall be made to determine compliance with the applicable dimensional requirements. Any dimension that is not within the specified tolerance shall be classified as a defect.

4.2.2.1 For tests. Sampling for tests shall be conducted in accordance with MIL-STD-105 and as indicated in table II. The unit of product for test purposes shall be one cane, or one wood sample.

TABLE II. Sampling criteria for tests

Characteristic	Requirement	Test procedure	Inspection level	AQL (percent defective)
Wood type	3.1	4.4.1	S-1	2.5
Moisture	3.1.1	4.4.2	S-1	2.5

4.3 Examination.

4.3.1 Examination of canes. The canes shall be examined to determine compliance with all requirements of this specification. The canes shall be examined for but not limited to the defects listed in table III. Additional defects shall be classified in accordance with MIL-STD-105.

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TABLE III. Classification of defects

Category	Defect
Major:	
101	Bent or distorted shaft.
102	Wood not free of splinters, decay, warping or splits.
103	Material other than specified.
104	Handle not integral with shaft.
105	Type II cane tips not beveled or rounded.
Minor:	
201	Surface not smoothly finished.
202	Finish not as specified.
203	Varnish or lacquer streaked or not smooth.

4.3.2 Examination for preparation for delivery. An examination shall be made to determine whether the packaging, packing and marking comply with the requirements of section 5. Defects shall be scored as specified in table IV. Sampling shall be in accordance with MIL-STD-105. The sample unit shall be one container fully prepared for delivery. The lot shall be the number of containers offered for inspection at one time. The inspection level shall be S-2 and the acceptable quality level shall be 4.0 percent defective.

TABLE IV. Examination for preparation for delivery

Examination	Defect
Containers	Not as specified.
Quantity	Quantity in interior packages or shipping containers not as specified.
Packaging and packing materials	Any component missing or damaged.
Markings	Omitted, incorrect, illegible, improper size, location, sequence, or method of application.

4.3.3 Examination of closure, waterproofing, and banding of containers. When shipping containers are required to comply with PPP-B-585, PPP-B-601, PPP-B-621, PPP-B-636, examination for defects in closure, waterproofing and banding shall be in accordance with the appendix to the applicable box specification.

4.4 Tests. Tests shall be conducted, to determine compliance with specification requirements.

4.4.1 Type of wood. The type of wood used in the fabrication of the canes shall be determined on the selected sample by methods in Publication No. 74, State University of New York, College of Environmental Science and Forestry, or equal industry method.

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4.4.2 Moisture content. The moisture content of the wood used in the fabrication of the canes shall be determined by the moisture meter or oven drying method of MIL-STD-1363. In case of dispute the oven drying method shall be used.

5. PREPARATION FOR DELIVERY

5.1 Packaging. Packaging shall be Level A or C, as specified (see 6.2).

5.1.1 Level A. Level A packaging shall consist of 48 unit packages contained in an intermediate package. Unit packages shall be one cane wrapped in kraft paper and secured with tape or one cane packaged in a kraft paper bag or in an envelope or sleeve of .0015 inch thick polyvinyl film. Closure of the unit package shall be adequate to prevent accidental opening. The intermediate package shall be 48 unit packages in a box constructed in accordance with PPP-B-636, type CF, class domestic. Closure of the box shall be as specified in the appendix of the box specification.

5.1.2 Level C. Units shall be clean, dry and individually packaged in a manner that will afford adequate protection against deterioration and physical damage during shipment from supply source to the first receiving activity.

5.2 Packing. Packing shall be level A, B or C as specified (see 6.2).

5.2.1 Level A. Two intermediate packages (96 units) shall be packed in an exterior container designed for a type 2 load and constructed in accordance with PPP-B-585, class 3, style 3; PPP-B-601, overseas type; PPP-B-621, class 2; or PPP-B-636, class weather-resistant, grade V3c. Closure and strapping shall be as specified in the appendix of the applicable box specification.

5.2.1.2 Case liner. Each level A wood box shall be lined with a waterproof case liner conforming to MIL-L-10547. Closure and sealing shall conform to applicable paragraph of appendix thereto. Case liner shall not be required for fiberboard boxes. Each fiberboard box shall be waterproofed as specified in PPP-B-636.

5.2.2 Level B. Two intermediate packages (96 units) shall be packed in an exterior container designed for a type 2 load and constructed in accordance with PPP-B-585, class 1, style 3; PPP-B-601, domestic type; PPP-B-621, class 1; or PPP-B-636, class domestic. Closure shall be as specified in the appendix of the applicable box specification.

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5.2.3 Level C. The packaged units shall be packed in shipping containers in a manner that will afford adequate protection against damage during direct shipment from the supply source to the first receiving activity. These packs shall conform to the applicable carrier's rules and regulations.

5.3 Marking.

5.3.1 Civil Agencies. Marking of shipment shall be in accordance with Fed. Std. No. 123.

5.3.2 Military Agencies.

5.3.2.1 Interior packages. Each unit package and each intermediate package shall be marked in accordance with MIL-STD-129. Contract or purchase order number and name of contractor shall be shown.

5.3.2.2 Exterior container. Exterior container shall be marked in accordance with MIL-STD-129.

6. NOTES

6.1 Intended use. The walking canes covered by this specification are intended for use by sick and injured personnel as an aid in ambulation.

6.2 Purchasers should select the preferred options offered herein and include the following information in procurement documents:

(a) Title, number, and date of this specification.
(b) Type, class (see 1.2) and length, type II, only (see 3.2).
(c) Selection of applicable levels of packaging and packing (see 5.1 and 5.2).
(d) Marking required (see 5.3).
(e) National stock number.

6.3 This specification covers the following item appearing in the Federal Supply Catalog:

National Stock Number	Item Identification	Specification Designation Type	Class
6515-00-774-0000	CANE, WALKING	I	A

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6.4 Type I cane Tip. The item in the Federal Supply Catalog designated to fit the type I cane is listed under National Stock Number 6515-01-013-3912.

6.5 This specification does not cover all types, classes, grades or sizes of the commodity indicated by the title of this specification, or those which are commercially available, but is intended to cover the types which are normally procured to meet Federal Government requirements.

Custodians:
Army - MD
Navy - MS
Air Force - 03

Review activity:
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Preparing activity:
DLA-DM

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GSA-FSS
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Project No. 6515-2041

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LLL-C-83B CANES, WALKING

NAME OF ORGANIZATION AND ADDRESS OF SUBMITTER

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